

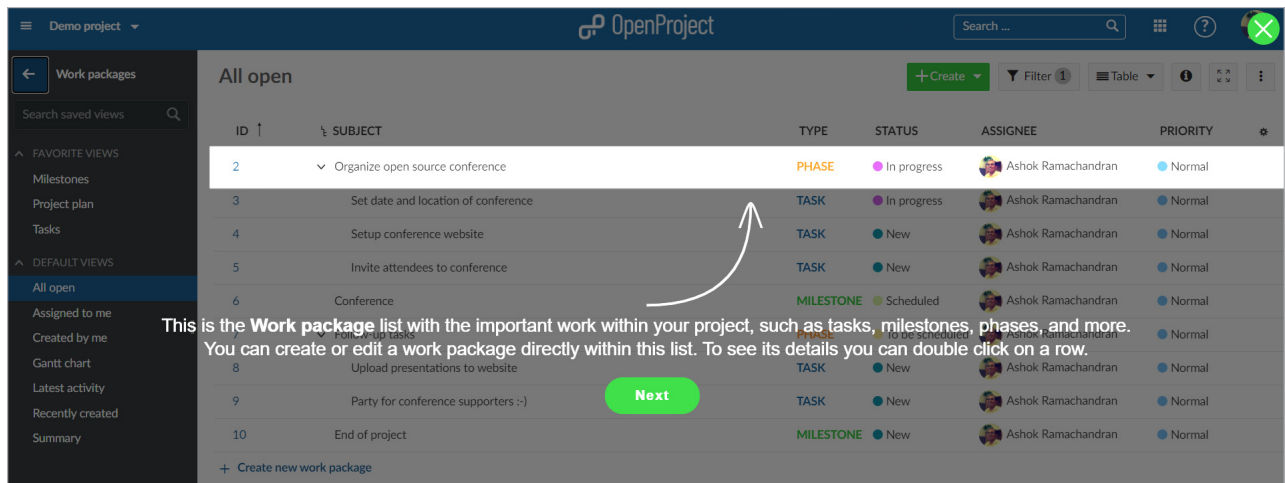


Figure 1: OpenProject guided tour

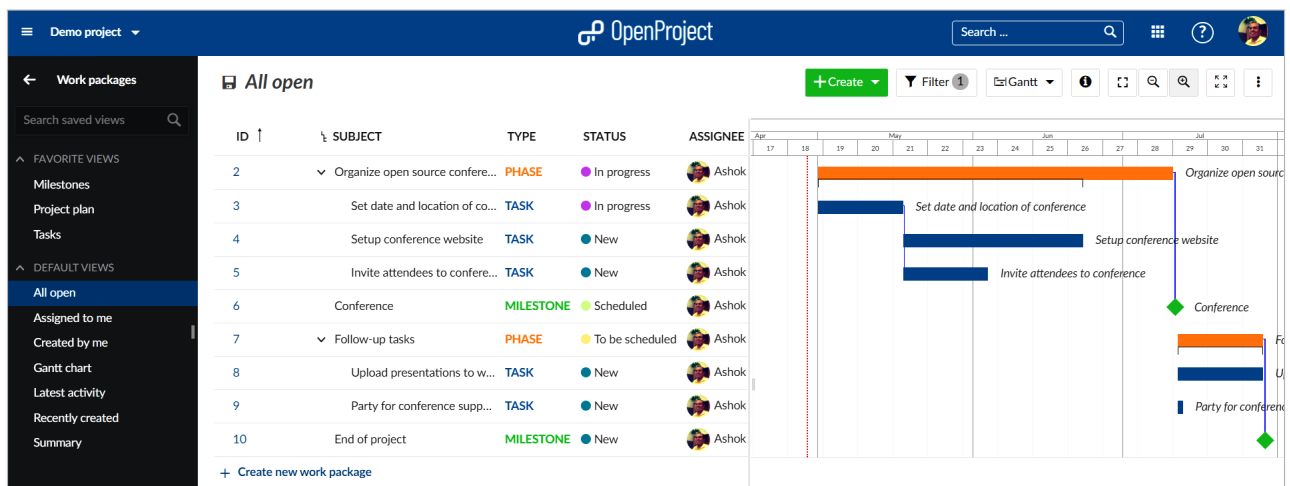


Figure 2: OpenProject Gantt chart

Install instructions and getting started

Most open source software is like a jackfruit — it looks uninviting with thorns on the outside. You have to put in some effort to get past these obstacles to get at the tasty fruit inside. Install instructions and getting started documents are indispensable to cross this ‘starting trouble’ stage successfully. The two open source tools that we feature here provide install instructions and ‘getting started’ tips for the total newcomer.

Being open source, there is no cost to downloading these tools and trying them out. However, a technical resource has to spend some amount of

time to install and configure them, and import or enter some test data to see whether the tools will suit your needs. Fortunately, both Redmine and OpenProject have online demos. You can register, enter some data and try these out to see whether they will serve your needs. Open Project CE has what they call a ‘3-min intro Guided Tour’. They practically hold your hand and walk you through the initial steps.

Based on this initial limited evaluation you can decide whether further effort is warranted. Open Project runs only on Linux while Redmine runs on Linux or a Windows server.

OpenProject CE - modern user interface

OpenProject follows the Freemium model. While the Enterprise Edition is commercial, the Community Edition (CE) is available as open source software. Modern user interfaces are built using what is known as ‘responsive’ technology. Such ‘responsive’ apps adapt the page layout and menu system to work on different sizes of screens including tablets and smartphones. In addition, they don’t unload and reload the entire page on each button press. They are very snappy as they refresh just the portion of the page with updated data. Also, they often allow *in-situ* editing in lists and forms,